

MLAX Player Wellness Survey Analysis - 2025 (Full Season)

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Executive Summary

This report presents a comprehensive analysis of daily wellness check-in data collected from the men's lacrosse team during the 2025 season. The primary objective is to assess player wellness using five known performance indicators (KPIs): **sleep quality, motivation, overall stress, physical fatigue, and soreness**.

The analysis distinguishes primary drivers, secondary drivers, and supporting indicators of wellness, while identifying meaningful differences across playing positions.

Key Findings:

1. Primary Drivers - **Strongest, most consistent statistical relationships with Wellness scores**
 - **Sleep Quality:** Players reporting better sleep quality consistently show higher overall wellness scores, making it a critical factor for performance and recovery.
 - **Motivation:** Higher motivation levels are strongly associated with better wellness scores, suggesting that psychological factors play a key role in athletes' overall health.
 - **Overall Stress:** Elevated stress levels are linked to lower wellness scores, particularly among certain positions, indicating that stress management may be an important area for intervention.
2. Secondary Drivers - **Statistically significant but slightly less dominant than primary drivers**
 - **Physical Fatigue:** Higher physical fatigue is associated with lower wellness scores, especially for positions with greater physical demands, highlighting the need for tailored recovery strategies.
 - **Soreness:** While soreness is related to wellness, it appears to be a less consistent predictor than sleep and motivation, suggesting it may be more of a symptom than a primary driver.
3. Supporting Indicators - **Contextual or moderating factors rather than standalone drivers**
 - **Position-Specific Patterns:** Certain positions (e.g., FO) show systematically lower wellness scores, which may reflect unique role demands or recovery challenges that require targeted support.
 - **Day of Week Effects:** Wellness scores vary by day of the week, with midweek check-ins reflecting training stress and recovery dynamics, while pre-game and post-game status may require separate assessment.

Position-Specific Findings:

1. Motivation has a much stronger relationship with wellness for Defense than for any other position. FO and OM players show greater representation in the lower motivation categories.
2. GK and D players are more likely to report Good or Excellent sleep quality. FO players show a higher concentration in the lower sleep quality categories.

3. Most players across all positions report soreness levels in the Moderate or Minimal categories.
4. FO and OM players show relatively higher representation in the higher fatigue categories. DM players are more frequently represented in the lower fatigue categories.
5. FO and A players show a higher concentration in the higher stress categories. DM, OM, and GK players are more concentrated in the lower stress categories.

Practical Implications:

1. Targeted Interventions

Focus on improving wellness factors through individualized support, and recovery protocols tailored to specific demands.

2. Response Rate Improvement

Implement strategies to increase survey participation, especially on days with lower response rates, to ensure more comprehensive data collection and accurate monitoring of player wellness. This will also give us more data to analyze trends across the week and identify critical periods for intervention.

3. Single day scores should not be over-interpreted

Wellness scores can fluctuate day-to-day based on training loads, recovery, and other factors. While certain patterns emerge at the group level, individual scores should be interpreted in context rather than as definitive indicators of performance or health on any given day. This underscores the importance of consistent monitoring and looking at trends over time rather than isolated data points.

Recommendations:

1. - **Increase the frequency of wellness surveys to capture more data across the week to address data gap.**
 - Tuesday's wellness scores will be our baseline scores for the week.
 - Thursday will inform adjustments to training loads and recovery strategies later in the week.
 - Friday surveys could assess pre-game readiness.
 - Sunday surveys could assess post-game recovery.
2. - **Use the change of individual wellness scores from Tuesday to Thursday as the primary inflection point.**
 - This change in the individual wellness score will flag athletes needing targeted interventions
3. - **Implement Athlete-Specific Z-Score Monitoring.**
 - Athlete readiness will be monitored using individualized Z-scores to flag meaningful drops from normal levels and support timely adjustments to training and recovery plans.
4. - **Educate athletes on the importance of wellness monitoring and self-care practices.**

- Provide resources and support to help athletes understand how sleep, motivation, stress, fatigue, and soreness impact their performance and recovery, empowering them to take proactive steps to optimize their wellness.

5. - Prioritize primary drivers

- This includes sleep quality, motivation, stress in wellness interventions, while also addressing secondary drivers fatigue, soreness, and position-specific needs.

6. - Tracking additional factors that may effect wellness

- Additional question added to the survey to track illness. This will help us understand how illness impacts wellness scores and recovery dynamics, and allow us to adjust training and recovery strategies accordingly.